

Critical document on using Notion

Introduction

For the development of my 2D rhythm game, Battle with the Rhythm, I used Notion to manage tasks, organize resources, and track progress. Instead of directly using a Board view, I created a Database, converted it into a Task Database, and then adapted it into a Sprint layout. This workflow allowed me to leverage Notion's flexibility to suit the needs of a solo game development project.

Use of Notion in the Project

1. Task management via Database and Sprint

I started by creating a Database in Notion

Then, I transformed it into a Task Database, adding fields such as:

- Task name
- Status (Not Started, In Progress, Done)
- Notes or references

After this, I enabled the Sprint feature via Turn on Sprint, which automatically generated a Sprint Board and a Sprints page.

This setup allowed me to manage tasks in a sprint workflow and track progress visually.

2. Resource and Reference Management

To organize all game assets, including music, sprites, and sound effects, I created a dedicated Resources Database in Notion. Each entry contains fields such as:

Name: The asset name

Type: Music, Sprite, or Sound Effect

Resource URL: Original download link or website

License: Licensing information e.g. Pixabay License, CC0

Notes: Usage instructions or additional remarks

By centralizing all assets in one database, I can quickly reference or verify resources while implementing features. Using online links allows me to save space and track original sources, while local backups ensure materials remain accessible.

Advantages

Visualization: Sprint layout provides clarity on task distribution and current progress.

Adaptability: Views and fields can be reconfigured as project needs evolve.

Disadvantages

Initial Complexity: Setting up a Database, converting it to Task, and enabling Sprint is more time-consuming than directly creating a Board view.

Learning Curve: Understanding multiple views, filters, and database fields requires practice.

Dependence on Internet: Full functionality requires online access.

Conclusion

Overall, Notion proved to be a valuable tool for managing Battle with the Rhythm. It balanced flexibility and structure, making task tracking, resource management, and progress logging more efficient. Despite minor setup complexity, it enhanced productivity and organization throughout the development process.